

Gustave Nganso

Lead Full Stack Developer & Founder | AI Products and Platforms

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SUMMARY

Principal engineer and founder with nearly 20 years shipping production software for financial services, media, and public sector clients, including 17 years running an independent consultancy end to end: winning engagements, scoping and negotiating contracts, delivering, and keeping clients like BMO, RBC, CIBC, and Scotiabank. Currently founder of Olochat AI Inc., where the job spans product direction, architecture, cost structure, and go-to-market, and also writing the code: RAG pipelines over Qdrant, open source LLMs served through Groq behind a dedicated proxy, evaluation in CI, and infrastructure as code with Terraform and Ansible.

LEADERSHIP HIGHLIGHTS

- Founded Olochat AI Inc. and set its product thesis (data sovereignty, honest unit economics, open and self-hostable infrastructure), then shipped the platform from first commit to production.
- Made the margin decisions early: self-hosted Postgres, Qdrant, ClickHouse, Redis, and Keycloak instead of managed services, with a tested three-layer backup strategy so cost discipline never became operational risk.
- Chose open source models served through Groq, behind a dedicated proxy that keeps the model layer swappable: no vendor lock-in, pricing leverage, and a model choice consistent with the product's openness thesis.
- Pitched pre-seed at ventureLAB.
- Co-founded Funzo (2020–2024), a developer training venture: built the curriculum and ran student cohorts as Agile teams for four years. Also led delivery teams on client work, including the front end team at Ericsson.
- Operates bilingually (English/French) across products, client work, and public speaking, with German as a third working language.

EXPERIENCE

Olochat AI Inc., Toronto 2025 – Present

Founder & CTO | Olotalk.com, a customer support AI SaaS that answers website visitors' questions from the customer's own content

Technologies: Python, TypeScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Qdrant, Redis, ClickHouse, Groq API (open source LLMs), Playwright, Docker Compose, Nginx, Terraform, Ansible, GitHub Actions

- Set product positioning around three pillars: sovereignty, economics, and openness. Running founding design partner outreach on that basis, with active conversations underway.
- Built the RAG pipeline personally: a Playwright-based crawler ingests site content, which is cleaned, chunked, and embedded into Qdrant, then retrieved at answer time to ground LLM responses.
- Routed all model calls through a dedicated AI proxy serving open source models on Groq, with per-tenant rate limiting backed by Redis and usage analytics in ClickHouse.
- Own quality and trust: accuracy and faithfulness checks in CI, hallucination guardrails, prompt version monitoring in production. In a product that answers on a customer's behalf, this is the business risk, so it is treated as such.
- Run the platform on Docker Compose behind Nginx, with infrastructure managed as code through Terraform and Ansible and deployments automated in GitHub Actions; instrumented with structured logs, metrics, and tracing through a shared telemetry package.

7971389 Canada Inc., Toronto 2009 – Present

Founder & Principal Consultant

- Have run the business side for 17 years (client acquisition, scoping, contracts, delivery) while staying hands-on in every engagement. Recent and selected work below.

BMO, Digital Core Cloud Center of Excellence, Senior Full Stack Developer 05/2024 – 05/2025

Technologies: Node.js, React, Next.js, AWS Lambda, IAM, DynamoDB, S3, GitHub Actions, Jenkins

- Built cloud migration tooling with a custom parser and colour-coded diff UI comparing on-premises and cloud configuration, replacing manual side-by-side reviews during migration audits.
- Designed and constructed REST and serverless API services on AWS Lambda, secured with IAM roles, policies, and STS, over DynamoDB and S3.

Funzo, Co-founder (Developer Training)

08/2020 – 08/2024

- Co-founded a developer training company; built and delivered the curriculum across JavaScript, TypeScript, React/Next.js, Vue.js/Nuxt.js, Node.js, Golang, and MongoDB.
- Ran student cohorts as Agile teams, with sprints, standups, retrospectives, and fixed delivery timelines; automated testing with Jest and Mocha was required in every project.
- Designed and taught the cloud track spanning GCP, AWS, and Azure on free tiers, so every student deployed at no cost: GKE, Cloud Run, Cloud Build pipelines, and BigQuery. Students shipped services to production as course work.

RBC, Enterprise Risk Management, Senior Full Stack Developer

11/2022 – 05/2024

Technologies: Python, Django, PostgreSQL, React, Redux, D3.js, Pytest, Jest, GitHub Actions

- Delivered an interactive risk dashboard over multi-source data; Python/Django REST services on PostgreSQL with tuned queries, working directly with risk analysts to shape requirements.
- Implemented graph-driven chart relationships using Dijkstra and topological sort algorithms.

HS GovTech Solutions, Senior Full Stack Developer (Public sector)

02/2021 – 07/2022

Technologies: TypeScript, Node.js, Express, AWS Lambda, MS SQL Server, MongoDB, Jest, Mocha

- Migrated a public sector product's backend from a monolith to serverless services; integrated MS SQL Server and MongoDB for relational and document data access.

MobileLIVE (Rogers, Fido, CIBC/Simplii), Senior Full Stack Developer

10/2018 – 12/2020

- Led the fido.ca migration from AngularJS to Angular 7 (NgRx, RxJS, TypeScript) and built money movement features for CIBC/Simplii, including Global Money Transfer.

Bell Media, Senior Front End Developer

01/2018 – 09/2018

- Built and maintained the Vidi in-house video player (on JW Player), deployed across 25 Bell brands with Adobe Analytics and advertising integration.

Ericsson, Senior Front End Developer & Team Lead

04/2017 – 12/2017

- Led the front end team building an operations dashboard for Proximus, the Belgian telecom, with AngularJS, Node.js, and D3.js.

Early Career

2003 – 2017

- Front end and full stack roles at Isobar (Disney), MobileLIVE (Rogers, Fido), Next Pathway (Scotiabank, Aimia), Critical Mass (Citibank, Nissan-Infiniti), TV Ontario, CBC Television, and Canadian Tire: UI architecture, data visualization, accessibility (WCAG/AODA), and front end performance for major media and financial clients.
- Earlier: Python/Django service conversions at BabyRobot and Starz Animation (2009–2010), the start of the Python track record; the Deutsche Bank project at CGI in Java; and three web applications for the Forest Research Institute Rheinland-Pfalz in Germany, where the career began in 2003.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **GenAI & LLM:** RAG, embeddings, Qdrant, prompt design, structured outputs, evaluation in CI, hallucination mitigation, open source LLMs served via Groq
- **Languages & frameworks:** Python (Django, Pytest), TypeScript/JavaScript (React, Next.js, Node.js), Golang, Rust
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, MS SQL Server, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, ClickHouse; query authoring and indexing
- **Cloud & operations:** AWS, Azure, GCP, Docker Compose, Nginx, Terraform, Ansible, GitHub Actions, Jenkins; structured logging, metrics, tracing

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Education: M.S. in Electrical Engineering, University of Kaiserslautern-Landau, Germany, 2006 • **Languages:** English, French, German